

Pat Summitt™

CHAMPIONING WOMEN IN LEADERSHIP



LESSON WORKBOOK

LESSON 1

Women at Work: The Current Situation

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. Take a minute to reflect on your own thoughts around women in the workplace. How have you viewed equality for women in the workforce in the past?

On a scale of 1 to 10, with 1 being “not equal” and 10 being “totally equal,” how close do you think we are to equality currently? There is no right or wrong answer. This is just a reflective exercise to get you to think about your own perceptions.

2. What are the biggest obstacles women face in your own organization?
3. Why do you think this is?
4. Are there any unique obstacles to female leadership in your organization?

Women at Work: The Current Situation

5. If you are a woman, which of these (if any) have you experienced before?
- Unequal pay
 - Unequal representation in certain fields
 - Caregiving/motherhood penalties
 - Underrepresentation in leadership
 - Gender stereotypes and biases
6. If you are male, which of the above inequalities is the most surprising to you, and which one are you the most curious to know more about?

LESSON 2

How Did We Get Here?

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. Of the stereotypes in this lesson, which have you been the most guilty of personally?

Share an example.

2. How has the workplace changed since your parent's generation?

3. How has your own industry changed?

4. Which of the biases have affected you the most personally in the past?
5. What specific examples of these have you witnessed with female leaders you know?

LESSON 3

Roadblocks for Women in Leadership

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. Take a minute to reflect. What percentage of leaders at your organization are women? What percentage of leaders at the board or senior-level are women?
2. Would you say women are overrepresented, underrepresented, or subordinately represented in your industry (or equally represented)?
3. Have you ever experienced a “pipeline issue” when trying to hire women for key positions at your organization?
4. How can you encourage or support women facing the confidence gap or the leadership trap?
5. Knowing what you now know, what do you think are two real obstacles facing female leaders at your own organization?

LESSON 4

The Glass Cubicle: Gender Microaggressions

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. What microaggressions have you noticed in your workplace or on your team? Are they one-offs, or are any reoccurring?

How can you take a step in eliminating these?

2. Of the three types of microaggressions, which do you feel are the most common?

• Verbal

• Nonverbal

• Institutional

3. If you are female, which microaggressions have affected you the most personally?
4. What are some microaggressions you've noticed toward the men on your team?

EXERCISE: FLIP THE SCRIPT

Instead of these gender-biased, verbal microaggressions, write down how you might say the same thing in a more unbiased way:

“Don’t be so emotional.”

“You talk too much.”

“You sounded mad.”

“She’s such a drama queen.”

“You need to fix your face.”

The Glass Cubicle: Gender Microaggressions

“Is it really that bad?”

“You’re too sensitive.”

“She was acting hormonal.”

LESSON 5

The Strength of Female Leadership

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. Think of some of the strong women leaders at your workplace. What unique qualities do they exhibit?
2. In what particular areas have you noticed women exhibiting a different approach than men in the workforce. Explain.
3. Do you agree with the statement in the lesson, “Equal doesn’t mean the same?” Why or why not?
4. For men: What are two things you can learn from your female team members?

The Strength of Female Leadership

5. For men: What are two things you can learn from your female team members?

6. For women: What are two things you can learn from your male team members?

7. Think of someone you know from the opposite sex who displays characteristics that go against the stereotypes for their gender. What are they? How does this contribute to the overall balance of the team?

LESSON 6

Climbing with Confidence

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. What is an example of a challenge from your own career that turned into an opportunity?
2. What does it mean to you to have a growth mindset?
3. In what specific areas do you need to grow? List three.
4. On a scale of 1 to 10, how would you rank yourself on being open to criticism?

Climbing with Confidence

5. Do you have career goals? Why or why not?

Take a moment to think of a few and list them here.

6. On a scale of 1 to 10, how would you rank your current friends or workplace community as being growth-minded?

7. What do you consider to be your three core strengths?

8. In this lesson, we discussed the importance of challenging negative thought patterns. Take a moment and list three negative thought patterns you may have as it relates to work.

*Climbing with Confidence***EXERCISE: MASTERING SELF-TALK**

After exploring the power of positive self-talk in this lesson, list at least three daily affirmations you can start with each morning:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

ADDITIONAL AFFIRMATIONS

Put these affirmations on index cards and keep them at your bedside or place them on your bathroom mirror for 30 days so you can see them when you first wake up. At the end of 30 days, you'll be amazed at the transformational power of positive thinking.

LESSON 7

Owning Your Game: The Power of Unapologetic Authenticity

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. Take a moment to reflect. In what ways might you have not been true to yourself this month at work? List at least two areas.
2. List two areas where you did display your authentic self at work.
3. What was the difference between the two scenarios? In #1, why did you feel led to hide your authentic self?

Owning Your Game: The Power of Unapologetic Authenticity

4. Of the list discussed in this lesson, which of these do you find yourself being guilty of, and why?
- Fear of judgment
 - Conforming to gender norms
 - Trying to impress others
 - Balancing act
 - Avoiding conflict
 - Over-apologizing
 - Downplaying achievements
5. What are three unique traits you have that no one else on your team has?
6. Do you regularly operate in those areas?
7. What are your boundaries or nonnegotiables at work?

EXERCISE: PERSONAL BRAND

1. What would you consider to be your current personal brand at work?
List up to five words that you feel like currently describe your brand (be honest!).
2. What would you *like* your personal brand to convey at work?
List the top five words.
3. Do a brand assessment this week with three colleagues you trust.
Ask them to list the top five words that come to mind when they think of you and why.
4. Now compare the three lists. Are they similar or different?
List the sets of words below.

Current Brand

Future Brand

Peer-Review Brand

LESSON 8

In It for the Long Haul

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. What does being a go-to team player mean to you?
2. Who is someone in your office who fits the description of go-to player? Why?
3. On a scale of 1 to 10, how successful do you feel in picking your battles at work?

In It for the Long Haul

4. How often do you struggle with burnout in your current position?

- Weekly
- Monthly
- Quarterly
- Hardly Ever

5. Of some of the potential causes of burnout described in this lesson, which are you most susceptible to:

- Excessive workload
- Lack of control
- Unclear expectations
- Lack of recognition
- Poor work-life balance
- Inadequate resources
- Other _____

LESSON 9

Communicating for Success: Getting the Message Across

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. Write the name of a coworker who excels in each of these areas:

Tone: _____

Situation: _____

Nonverbal communication: _____

Eye contact: _____

Posture: _____

Gestures: _____

Facial expressions: _____

Take a moment to reflect. What can you learn from each of the coworkers you listed above?

Why?

Communicating for Success: Getting the Message Across

2. Of the three types of communication Pat outlined, which of these do you currently struggle with the most:

- Tone
- Situation
- Nonverbal Communication

3. Of the nonverbal communication types listed, which do you think you are the best at currently?

- Eye Contact
- Posture
- Gestures
- Facial Expressions
- Active Listening

4. How often do you use qualifier words in everyday conversation?

5. Which two qualifier or filler words listed in this lesson can you eliminate this week?

LESSON 10

Powerful Conversations

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. What is your current leader's communication style?

How about their leader?

2. Which of these three principles do you find most challenging when communicating up?

• Right channel • Right timing • Right message

3. What is something specific you can do this week to optimize personal one-on-ones with your leader?

4. Think about the last time you had to have a hard conversation at work. How did it go? What could you have done better?

5. On a scale of 1 to 10, how would you rate yourself on having hard conversations at work?

LESSON 11

Mastering the Boardroom: Negotiation for Women

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. On a scale of 1 to 10, how would you rate your current comfort level with negotiating?

Why?

2. What is the most challenging thing you face personally when attempting to negotiate?
3. List three areas of your life (professional or personal) where you have to negotiate on a daily basis?
4. Have you ever had to negotiate your salary at work? What was the outcome?
5. List the areas you need to improve when it comes to the art of negotiation.

LESSON 12

Thriving Together: Women Supporting Women

EXERCISE: YOUR TEAM

Write the names of at least three women in each column that you could recruit to be on your Championship Team.

Work BFFs**Comrades-in-Arms****Coaches****Mentors**

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. Do you have a mentor in your current profession?

List at least two individuals who you feel have mentored you in the past (formally or informally).

2. Who might you ask to be an additional mentor in your current role?
List at least three potential candidates.

- CHAMPIONING WOMEN IN LEADERSHIP WITH PAT SUMMITT | Lesson Workbook | pg 25

CONCLUSION

How to Create an Environment That Supports Female Leaders

PERSONAL REFLECTIONS

1. On a scale of 1 to 10, how would you rate gender-neutrality in your current hiring process?
2. What are some steps you could take to further eliminate any room for gender bias?
3. Which roles at your organization have been traditionally held by one particular gender?
4. What are some things you can do to encourage an equal mix of genders to apply?

How to Create an Environment That Supports Female Leaders

5. Do you have a standardized performance review template at your organization? Why or why not?

6. What steps could you take to make sure review criteria are equal and gender neutral?

7. Take a moment to reflect on your team-building and extracurricular activities. Are they geared toward traditionally male activities, female activities, or both?

8. What are three additional steps you can take today to move toward gender equality in your workplace culture?